

- **The house near railroad tracks.** Unless you *enjoy* being woken up in the middle of the night by the sound of trains rushing by.
- **The house adjacent to a highway.** If a house is *near* a highway, that could be a potential benefit to home buyers with a commute—but if it's *adjacent* to the highway, you'll get a lot of unwanted noise.
- **The house near high-voltage power lines.** Studies on this are mixed, but some reliable sources claim that exposure to magnetic fields can cause cancer. Whether or not this information is conclusive, a lot of people know about it, and it might cause issues selling the house down the road. (And, you know, better safe than sorry.)
- **The house with a flat roof.** Now, this isn't a total deal breaker, especially if you live somewhere that doesn't get snow. But if your winter looks as much like back-of-wardrobe Narnia as ours does, a flat roof can trap the snow and turn into a disaster. It's easy to forget to look at the roof, so just give it a quick glance before you go inside any house you're viewing.
- **The weird house.** Don't get us wrong—we love a good hideous house that can be fixed up to add value. "Weird" is harder to define, but you'll know it when you see it. Three, four, or even five bedrooms is normal, but once you start getting into six bedrooms, a house turns weird—especially if it has only one or two bathrooms. A two-story house is normal, three is a bit odd, and anything four or more is strange. Just consider anything that you *won't* be able to change with renovations. Geodesic dome houses might be neat to look at, but they're a nightmare to sell.

These are all features you can see and hear while you're viewing properties, so you can nix a few of your options right off the bat. We'll cover more deal breakers later, but those will be the kind you might not be able to pick out on your own. You will need a home inspector on your side, so we'll dive into those when we get to Chapter Eleven.

If you're walking through a home that you realize you aren't interested in purchasing, leave. You are under no obligation to continue to see every part of the house. If there is something you hate or a deal breaker of any kind, simply walk out the door. Crumbling walls in the basement that signal